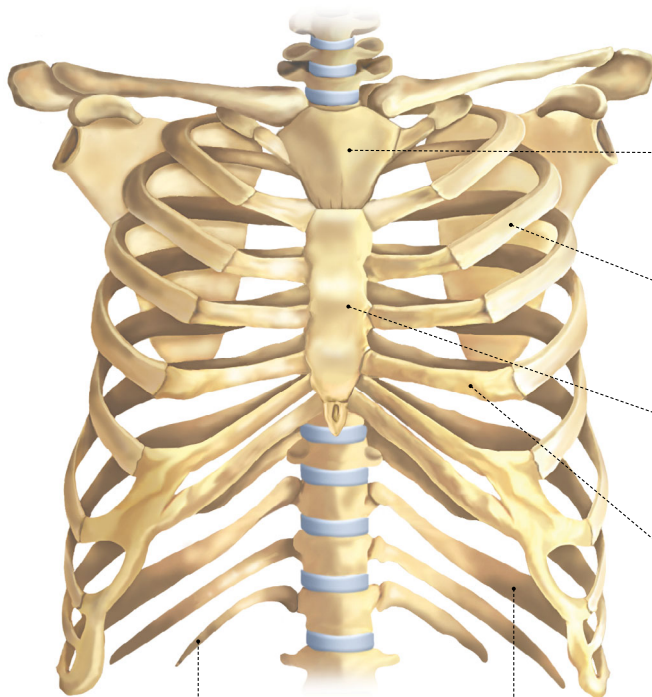


**thoracic cage**

Bony structure composed of 12 pairs of ribs articulated with the 12 thoracic vertebrae and the sternum. It covers and protects the organs of the thorax.

manubrium

Upper part of the sternum, which articulates with the first two costal cartilages and the clavicles.

true rib (7)

Thin curved bone, one end of which articulates with the thoracic vertebrae; the other end attaches to the sternum.

sternum

Long flat bone to which the ribs, in particular, are attached.

costal cartilage

Elongated cartilage at the end of the rib that articulates with the sternum.

floating rib (2)

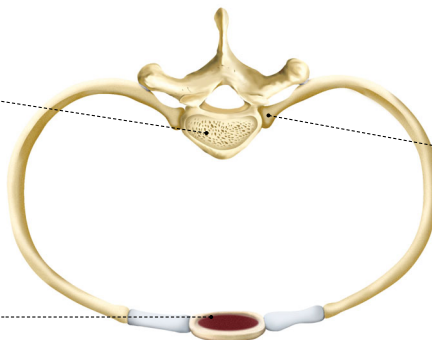
Thin curved bone articulating with the dorsal vertebrae at one end and remaining free at the other end.

false rib (3)

Slender curved bone articulated with the dorsal vertebrae at one end and attached to the upper rib at the other end.

thoracic vertebra

Bone supporting the ribs, located between the cervical and lumbar vertebrae.

**rib**

Long, flat arc-shaped bone; the ribs form the sides of the ribcage.

head of rib

Posterior extremity of a rib, which articulates with a thoracic vertebra at two attachment points.

sternum

Long flat bone to which the ribs, in particular, are attached.